

FIGURE 2.4 Klaus Franke, “Davis, Angela, East Berlin: Visits East German Border with West Berlin,” September 1972. (Bundesarchiv, Bild 183-L0912-412)

Davis’s ability to convincingly displace the Berlin Wall in the American imagination worked to reaffirm her networks of solidarity. She almost completely bypassed the American cultural fascination with the Berlin Wall and attempted to reorient people toward other divisions: in particular, the liberation politics of struggle against Cold War strategies of containment and, with greater focus, the harsh, politicized, and racialized contours of the U.S. prison system. On subsequent trips or in public discourse, Davis was not recorded pondering or directing a self-conscious gaze onto the Berlin Wall or East German border control. The Wall proved to be somewhat of a haunt to Davis, a topic of non-acknowledgment lurking in public exchanges about her time in Germany, even when she was physically close to the Wall